

Differentiate live walkthrough vs. individual usage

KayCee Galano: Young Professional Violinist

Brief Bio and Accomplishments

Kristine Clair “KayCee” Uchi Galano is recognized as a leading young violinist. She has performed as a soloist with orchestras across Europe, China, North America, and her native Philippines.

Her major accomplishments include:

- **Winning first prize** at the Mary Lane Memorial Violin Competition (2021).
- Participating in the Shanghai Isaac Stern International Violin Competition and the International Violin Competition of Indianapolis.
- Making her **Carnegie Hall debut** in October 2019 by performing all six Bach solo sonatas.
- Winning major prizes in Beijing, Malaysia, and the USA from a young age, and being featured on NPR’s “From The Top” at age 12.
- Extensive chamber music and festival participation at programs like the Perlman Music Program, Kneisel Hall, and Bowdoin International Music Festival.
- She is currently a student at the University of Cincinnati College-Conservatory of Music, studying with Kurt Sassmannshaus.

User Study Notes:

Experience & Roles

- **Experience with Music Ensembles:** Loves playing in chamber music settings (trios, quintets) and collaborating with others for recitals and special performances.
- **Usual Roles in Ensembles:** Typically plays either violin 1 or violin 2. Describes her role as a “**servant leader**,” taking initiative when needed but always listening to the group.

Repertoire & App Feedback

- **Challenges with Finding Repertoire:** Notes that most standard repertoire (18th and 19th centuries) is easily accessible through IMSLP and libraries. Comfortable improvising but appreciates sheet music for convenience.
- **Feedback on Your App (for ensemble music):** Sees it as a great idea for the **gigging world** (weddings, jam sessions) where custom arrangements are often needed.
- **Desired Features/Guardrails:** Requested Features include **Counterpoint** (sees it as a potential “game-changer”), support for **more instruments**, and the creation of **group categories**.

Ethical Concerns & AI Impact

- **Ethical Concerns:** Hopes the app will be a **co-creative tool and not a replacement** for human arrangers. Notes the need for education to prevent misuse (e.g., for theory homework).
- **Impact of AI on Music:** Believes AI can **never fully replace live performance**. Wants to focus on creating the best tool to help musicians in the gigging community.

Aldren Briones: Songwriter & Multi-Instrumentalist

Brief Bio

Aldren Briones is a songwriter fond of sappy puns and bright ukulele parts. His musical inspirations include Billy Joel, twenty one pilots, and Jacob Collier. He has released music as both singles and the EP “reasons (i can’t sleep),” and is a member of the group concept_mix.

User Study Notes:

Experience & Roles

- **Experience with Music Ensembles:** Extensive background (up to 15 years) in choir, personal bands, pit orchestra, and church ensembles. Deep experience in both ensemble and choral settings.
- **Usual Roles in Ensembles:** Describes himself as a **loyal follower**, helping other members and participating rather than leading.

Repertoire & App Feedback

- **Challenges with Finding Repertoire:** Finds repertoire limited or hard to locate, especially for specific piano arrangements. Enjoys arranging but wishes the process were faster.
- **Feedback on Your App (for ensemble/arranging):** A cool starting point for composers and arrangers. Notes, harmonies, and bass lines can sometimes seem **"off,"** creating a “second version.” Likes the help with arranging.
- **Desired Features/Guardrails:**
 - **Guardrails:** To avoid using the tool on unreleased music.
 - **Requested Features:** Harmony regeneration, chord notation, and seeded regeneration.

Ethical Concerns & AI Impact

- **Ethical Concerns:** Mild worries about composers/arrangers feeling replaced. Would be cautious using it for unreleased/new music or if it replaced studio arrangement work.
- **Impact of AI on Music:** Think tools like this **can’t replace live music or creativity.**

Co-Design and User Control

- **Co-Design and User Control:** Favors **co-design** with more user choice and editing between input and output. Wants freedom to select style or genre, edit along the way, and see more options between input and final arrangement.

Kristin Vaziri: Music Educator & Director

Brief Bio

Kristin Vaziri is a music educator and director with experience spanning orchestral, mariachi, and community ensembles. She has been playing music since 4th grade, studied music education and performance in college, and currently directs ensembles for D62 while performing professionally with groups such as the DuPage Symphony Orchestra. Vaziri is recognized for her work leading multiple mariachis, arranging and transposing repertoire for diverse genres, and actively participating in both educational and community music settings.

User Study Notes:

Experience & Roles

- **Experience with Music Ensembles:** Lifelong musician (since 4th grade); performer with the DuPage Symphony Orchestra; **Director for Algonquin Middle School string ensembles and multiple mariachis.**
- **Usual Roles in Ensembles: "All of the above":** leader (arranger, orchestra director), follower (ensemble participant), and concertmaster as situations demand. Believes an educator/performer should be both a leader and a follower.

Repertoire & App Feedback

- **Challenges with Finding Repertoire:** Regularly arranges and transposes music, particularly necessary for **mariachi music**, which has limited centralized resources and relies on manual transcription. Classical music is more accessible, but arranging is still time-consuming, especially for genre-specific rules.
- **Feedback on Your App (for ensemble/arranging):** Good **entry point for new composers/educators or students**. Valuable for quick harmonies or educational gigs; a great "gateway" for composition dabbling. Suggests **customizable settings for genre-specific** music theory constraints.
- **Desired Features/Guardrails:**
 - **Guardrails:** To ensure adaptable use and support, **not replacement**. AI should be a tool, not a decider.
 - **Instrument expansion:** Add options for Chamber Ensemble, Wind Ensemble, Symphony Orchestra, and bigger groups.
 - **More control:** Over harmony texture, doubling, extensions, ostinatos, etc.

Ethical Concerns & AI Impact

- **Ethical Concerns:** Supports human intervention and creativity; **does not want AI to "have the final say."** Values keeping the creative process with musicians.
- **Impact of AI on Music:** Sees the tool as supportive, not a replacement—should encourage human creativity—favors adaptive integration with individual musical tastes.

Co-Design and User Control

- **Co-Design and User Control:** Favors a **fully co-designed approach—beyond "one click."** Emphasizes strong user choice in settings, group selection, and editorial input between app suggestions and final output.

Raw Notes

1. Kaycee Galano
 - a. What has your experience been with music ensembles?

- i. Love playing chamber music and playing with people – smaller chamber groups, trios, quintets – jumping around groups until recitals and such
 - b. What role have you usually found yourself in ensembles? (Leader, follower, etc.)
 - i. Either violin 1 or 2, usually the servant leader, feels out the group chemistry, and if there's something they feel strongly about, then they say something
 - c. Have you ever struggled with finding more repertoire to play?
 - i. Most pieces are 18th- and 19th-century, so most standard pieces people want to play are already available via IMSLP, major music publishers, conservatory libraries, etc.
 - ii. Gonna have to improvise, don't really need sheet music, just know chords and harmonies, nice to have sheet music as it's the easiest way to jam and learn.
 - d. Show app:
 - e. What are your initial thoughts?
 - i. Great idea for the gigging world (not necessarily for the classical world yet)—weddings, caroling, jamming, etc.—may not have arrangements readily available, especially for weddings that request songs to be in group formations like quartets and trios.
 - ii. Hopefully, in the future, we will have melodies distributed across instruments.
 - f. Do you have any ethical concerns about this app?
 - i. What happens to all these arrangers?
 - ii. Hope for this app to be a co-creative tool, and humans need to learn how to evolve and adapt to it—adjust for composers/arrangers/classes
 - iii. Helping undergrad students with theory homework—if my app can do counterpoint, it might be banned lol
 - iv. AI can never take over performance
 - v. Anything that can be digitized will be digitized
 - vi. Make it the best product I can make to help people
 - vii. Definitely the gigging community
 - g. What additional guardrails would you like for this app?
 - i. Not so far
 - h. What additional features would you like to see in this app?
 - i. Counterpoint, add more instruments, and group categories
 - ii. If this thing can figure out counterpoint, that would be a game-changer.
2. Aldren Briones
- a. What has your experience been with music ensembles?
 - i. Choir high through college, gig bands and personal band where he writes and arranges musicals, plays in pit orchestra, and church—decade to fifteen years, ensemble to choir stuff
 - b. What role have you usually found yourself in ensembles? (Leader, follower, etc.)
 - i. A loyal follower who has helped out other followers, being just a member
 - c. Have you ever struggled with finding more repertoire to play?
 - i. Repertoire feels very limited or hard to find when you don't know what you're looking for—a specific piano arrangement doesn't feel what you want it to be
 - d. H

- i. Likes arranging, but when it's hard to bridge the parts together, spends more time arranging than performing. If there were a way to make the arranging process quicker, that would be great.
 - e. Show app:
 - f. What are your initial thoughts?
 - i. Cool starting off point for composers and arrangers
 - ii. Harmonies don't sound too right—really interesting
 - iii. Bass line isn't what I imagine when I hear this song, and viola part jumps around a lot—a distorted reharmonization
 - iv. It feels like a second version of the song with a different harmony
 - v. Likes the idea of help with arranging
 - g. Do you have any ethical concerns about this app?
 - i. Not too much, but might be some pushback from people who arrange and compose (obviously), find trouble in feeling like this might be a replacement
 - h. What additional guardrails would you like for this app?
 - i. I would be wary of using this on new music, like stuff that hasn't been released before
 - ii. If people are using this to really replace arrangements and studio gigging or improvisation, etc.
 - i. What additional features would you like to see in this app?
 - i. Enable a feature to regenerate harmonies
 - ii. Seeded regeneration
 - iii. And chord notation co-design
 - iv. Alongside the melody, and includes other parts (polyphonic)
 - j. Co-design design vs. one-click
 - i. Freedom to choose things—add more editing in between and more options, maybe even like a style or a genre, more options in between inputting and outputting
- 3. Kristin Vaziri
 - a. What has your experience been with music ensembles?
 - i. Musician since 4th grade
 - ii. Went to college for music education, performing with music ensembles, and the university orchestra
 - iii. Ensemble director for D62
 - iv. A part of the concertos and currently an active member of the DuPage Symphony orchestra
 - v. Gigs for weddings, parties, first Messiah gig performed with arias as a concert
 - b. What role have you usually found yourself in ensembles? (Leader, follower, etc.)
 - i. All of the above
 - ii. As a good musician and a teacher, you need to be both a leader and a follower
 - iii. If you are a director or a music educator, you should be in a music ensemble while being a teacher/director/music educator, as those two feed each other
 - iv. Leader in arranging music and directing orchestra, and follower/learner in her own orchestra, being a violinist and concert master

- c. Have you ever struggled with finding more repertoire to play?
 - i. Yes
 - ii. Having to arrange and transpose music
 - iii. Running two mariachis and other ensembles
 - 1. In the mariachi world, there isn't a wide database where you can get music. It's a lot of word of mouth and people actually arranging and writing music down, but not a lot of centralization.
 - iv. In the classical world, there are forums and JWPepper, etc., so it's a bit easier.
- d. Struggles in arranging
 - i. With orchestra stuff, it's fine, a "machine that goes."
 - 1. Orchestral music is still based on the music theory rules that have been around for hundreds of years
 - ii. The struggle is with mariachi
 - 1. For cultural music like mariachi, there are specific music theory laws that make it sound "mariachi".
 - 2. Dabbling and arranging, and presenting cultural music that she didn't grow up with, but still wants to collaborate and make it sound like what her kids are accustomed to.
 - 3. Struggle with learning new and different music theory nuances to arrange more music, not necessarily for classical but for mariachi.
- e. Show app:
- f. What are your initial thoughts?
 - i. I think this is a really cool gateway for people that are wanting to dabble in composing but don't have the professional training
 - 1. Students, kids, initial composer
 - ii. Great tool for educators who need a quick harmony or gig
 - iii. Giving a jump-off point
 - 1. Potentially add settings for specific music theory laws or groups
- g. Do you have any ethical concerns about this app?
 - i. I like that the way the development is very supportive and needs the human touch, needing and giving the creativity to the human and needing it rather than giving AI the full power
 - ii. It's a means to an end for us creatively, but still warrants human intervention
- h. What additional guardrails would you like for this app?
 - i. The main concern is still allowing people to adaptively integrate it into their own musical tastes
 - ii. Not letting AI have the final say
 - iii. Using it in a more supportive role
- i. What additional features would you like to see in this app?
 - i. More instruments
 - ii. Groups like Chamber Ensemble, Wind Ensemble, and Symphony Orchestra
 - iii. Larger ensembles
 - 1. Harmony texture vs. doubling melodies, etc.
 - iv. Extensions, ostinatos, etc.

- j. Co-design design vs. one-click
 - i. Completely co-design design